LISTEN · LEARN · SPEAK

Why We Forget Things and How to Remember More

Why doorways make us forget, how fast new words disappear, the study trick that beats reading again and again, natural English for remembering and forgetting – and Rafael's winners' box.



Name: _____

Date: _____

My score: _____ / 100 ⭐

★ How to use this worksheet

1 · Before you listen 🧠
Do the warm-up and learn the key words. Questions with 🧠 can be answered before listening.

2 · While you listen 🎧
Answer the 🎧 questions. The ⏱ times show where to find each part of the video.

3 · Tomorrow 📅
Lucy's tip: do the crossword and the brain dump **tomorrow** – forget a little first, then recall!

0 Warm-up: My memory check

fun · no points

Be honest! Tick everything that is true for you. 😄

- ☐ 🚪 I forget why I'm in a room
- ☐ 👅 I often can't find a word
- ☐ 🃏 I use flashcards
- ☐ 🔑 I often lose my keys
- ☐ 📖 I study by re-reading
- ☐ 🎂 I remember birthdays

My memory score: _____ / 6

Guess! Students read a text four times – or read it once and tried to recall it three times. A week later, who remembered more?

(a) the readers (b) the recallers (c) no difference

🎧 **Check your guess at ⏱ 8:40**

Lucy: "Highlighters in every colour – and very little left a week later!" 🖍️



💬 Let's talk

Say your answers out loud – or write them in your notebook.

1. What do you often forget? Keys, names, birthdays?

2. How do you usually learn new English words?

3. Who in your family has a really good memory?

4. What did you learn by heart at school?

1 Key words

vocabulary · 10 points

Match each word or phrase (1–10) to its meaning (a–j). Write the letter in the box. 🧠 Then check at ⏱️ 15:10 and ⏱️ 16:10

- ☐ **1.** to recall
- ☐ **2.** forgetful
- ☐ **3.** to slip your mind
- ☐ **4.** to jog someone's memory
- ☐ **5.** to brush up on
- ☐ **6.** on the tip of my tongue
- ☐ **7.** a boundary
- ☐ **8.** to remind someone
- ☐ **9.** spaced repetition
- ☐ **10.** to stick (in your memory)

a) to study something again, because you've forgotten some of it
b) a line between two areas, like a border
c) to bring something back into your mind, with some effort
d) to stay in your memory
e) you almost remember a word, but you can't quite say it
f) often forgetting things
g) to help someone remember with a small clue
h) looking at things again over several days, just before you forget
i) to be forgotten by accident – usually something you needed to do
j) to tell someone about something, so they don't forget it



Pronunciation corner 🔊 re-**CALL** · for-**GET**-ful · re-**MIND** · **BOUN**-da-ry · sieve (/sɪv/ – like "give"). Fun fact: the **t** in **often** is usually silent: /ˈɒfn/. Say it: *"It's on the tip of my tongue!"*

2 First listen: the big idea

listening · 2 points

Watch the whole episode once without stopping. Which sentence is the **main message**? 🎧

- (a) If you forget new words quickly, something is wrong with your memory.
- (b) The best way to learn is to read your notes again and again.
- (c) Forgetting is normal – but testing yourself a little, again and again over several days, helps words stick.



Jack's tip: First listen = the **big picture**. Don't stop the video and don't worry about every word. Second listen = the **details**. That's when you answer the 🎧 questions.

🔮 **Predict before you listen!** (no points) Seven of these words are in the episode. One is **not**. Circle the one you think you **won't** hear – then check while you listen.

scissors · parcel · fridge · elephant · sieve · flashcards · camera · soup

3 Know it or hear it? quiz + listening 10 points

Circle a, b or c. Questions 🧠 1–5: you can probably answer them **before** you listen. Questions 🎧 6–10: listen to find the answer.



🧠 YOU MIGHT ALREADY KNOW

1. "Can you _____ me to call my mum?"

(a) remember
(b) remind
(c) memory

🧠 Tricky – think about it!

2. "Oh no! I _____ my keys at home."

(a) left
(b) forgot
(c) lost

🧠 Tricky – think about it!

3. "Sorry I didn't call. It completely _____ my mind."

(a) fell
(b) ran
(c) slipped

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

4. "I've got a memory like a sieve." My memory is…

(a) excellent
(b) all about cooking
(c) very bad

🧠 Imagine it!

5. If you learn something "by heart", you…

(a) learn it quickly and forget it
(b) know it so well you can say it without looking
(c) learn it with love

🧠 Everyday English

🎉 **How many did you know?**
Now press play and test your ears!

🎧 LISTEN AND FIND OUT

6. What did Jack need from the kitchen?

(a) the scissors
(b) a knife
(c) some tape

🎧 ⏱️ 0:05

7. In Radvansky's first experiments, people…

(a) cooked in a real kitchen
(b) read short stories
(c) played a computer game

🎧 ⏱️ 3:04

8. What did Ebbinghaus learn to test his memory?

(a) real English words
(b) nonsense syllables
(c) long numbers

🎧 ⏱️ 6:01

9. The 2015 study in Amsterdam found that the forgetting curve…

(a) had disappeared
(b) was very close to the original
(c) went up every day

🎧 ⏱️ 6:01

10. What did Rafael's sister call the box?

(a) the lucky box
(b) the English box
(c) the winners' box

🎧 ⏱️ 21:20

✂️ **Fun fact:** Jack's third trip to the kitchen worked – he said *"scissors, scissors, scissors"* out loud all the way there!

4 True or false? listening 6 points

Listen and circle **T** (true) or **F** (false). The ⏱️ times help you find the answer.

1	Jack walked into the kitchen three times in ten minutes.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
2	In the real rooms, people could see the objects inside the boxes.	T	F	⏱️ 3:04
3	Most forgetting happens in the first hours and days.	T	F	⏱️ 6:01
4	Ebbinghaus tested hundreds of people in his experiment.	T	F	⏱️ 6:01
5	Sleep is proven to be the reason for the small jump at 24 hours.	T	F	⏱️ 6:01
6	The students who read the text four times felt the most confident.	T	F	⏱️ 8:40

5 Three memory studies 🔍 listening 6 points



Which study is each sentence about? Write **A**, **B** or **C**. ⏱️ 3:04 · 6:01 · 8:40

A · Doorways 🚪
2011 · Gabriel Radvansky, University of Notre Dame

B · The forgetting curve 📉
1880s · Ebbinghaus – and again in 2015, in Amsterdam

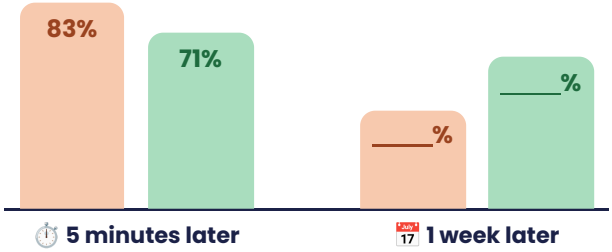
C · Testing yourself 📝
2006 · Roediger & Karpicke, Washington Univ. in St. Louis

1	Students read a science text four times – or once, and then recalled it three times.	☐
2	People carried objects they couldn't see through virtual rooms.	☐
3	One person learned lists of invented words like "dax" and "bok".	☐
4	Your brain thinks: "That scene is finished – a new scene is starting."	☐
5	After a week, the result completely flipped.	☐
6	At around 24 hours, the curve went up a little.	☐

6 Read it or recall it? new! read the chart 6 points



A. Listen at ⏱️ 8:40 and complete the chart (1 point each). **B.** Is each one recognising or recalling? (1 point each)



📖 read the text 4 times

🧠 read it once, then recalled it 3 times

Write the two missing numbers for "1 week later".

1. 📖 You read your word list again, and it all looks familiar.	☐ 👀 recognising	☐ 🧠 recalling
2. 🙈 You cover the English side of your list and say the words.	☐ 👀 recognising	☐ 🧠 recalling
3. 🗣️ You explain a new word to a friend without looking.	☐ 👀 recognising	☐ 🧠 recalling
4. 👀 You see "cosy" in a text and think, "Oh yes, I know that one!"	☐ 👀 recognising	☐ 🧠 recalling

7 "It's on the tip of my tongue!" listening 10 points



Two friends are talking about a restaurant – but Lucy can't remember its name. Listen at ⏱️ 14:21 and write **one word** in each gap (1–8). Then answer A and B. The breakdown at ⏱️ 15:10 can help.

JACK
You know, we should go back to that restaurant we went to last 1 _____. The one with the amazing soup.

LUCY
Yes! What was it 2 _____ again? It's on the tip of my 3 _____.

JACK
It was something 4 _____. Bella… something?

LUCY
No, that's not it. Hang on, give me a 5 _____. It started with an M.

JACK
Does "the place near the 6 _____" help? Maybe that'll jog your memory.

LUCY
Marco's! It was Marco's. I knew it would come 7 _____ to me.

JACK
Finally. Well, don't forget to book a table this time. Last time, it completely slipped your mind.

LUCY
That was one time! Okay, 8 _____ me tomorrow, and I'll do it straight away.

A. The restaurant is called _____.

B. This time, Lucy must _____ a table.

8 Phrases to steal expressions 4 points

Match each phrase from the chat (1–4) to its meaning (a–d). ⏱️ 15:10

- ☐ **1.** "What was it called again?"
- ☐ **2.** "Hang on, give me a second."
- ☐ **3.** "Maybe that'll jog your memory."
- ☐ **4.** "I knew it would come back to me."

a) Please wait a moment.
b) I was sure I'd remember it again.
c) I knew this before, but I've forgotten.
d) That might help you remember.

🗣️ **Word on the tip of your tongue? Describe it!** (no points) Don't stop talking – the other person will often say the word for you.

It's a thing you use to… **It's a kind of…** **It's like a…, but…** **It's the opposite of…**

Describe one without saying the word – ✂️ scissors · 🥣 a sieve · 🐘 an elephant:

9 Memory phrases

idioms · 6 points



Complete each sentence with a word from the box. ⏱️ 16:10 · 19:14

forgetful **heart** **jog** **slipped** **stick** **up**

1. 📚 I learned all the irregular verbs by _____ at school.
2. ✈️ I need to brush _____ on my English before my trip.
3. 👴 My grandad is getting a bit _____ – but he's still very funny.
4. 🔁 I read the words again and again, but they don't _____.
5. 📞 Sorry I didn't call you – it completely _____ my mind.
6. 📷 Maybe this old photo will _____ your memory.



Jack's tip: "It slipped my mind" is a polite way to say *"I forgot"* – it sounds like it wasn't really your fault! 😉 And **"jog"** normally means to run slowly – so you give your memory a little push to start running. 🏃

10 Remember to… or remember -ing?

new! grammar · 6 points



Tick the right form.

📝 **remember / forget + to do** = a job you need to do. *"Remember to call Mum!"*

📸 **remember / forget + -ing** = a memory of the past. *"I remember meeting her."*

1. Please remember _____ a table for Saturday! 🍝
☐ 📝 to book ☐ 📸 booking

2. I remember _____ Rafael for the first time. 🤝
☐ 📝 to meet ☐ 📸 meeting

3. Don't forget _____ yourself tomorrow! 🃏
☐ 📝 to test ☐ 📸 testing

4. I'll never forget _____ the winners' box. 🏆
☐ 📝 to see ☐ 📸 seeing

5. Did you remember _____ your keys? 🔑
☐ 📝 to take ☐ 📸 taking

6. I remember _____ "go, went, gone" at school. 🏫
☐ 📝 to learn ☐ 📸 learning

💡 Six ways to remember more

match · no points



Match each tip (1–6) to an example (a–f). Then tick the two you'll try this week! ⏱️ 11:41

☐ **1.** 🙈 Test yourself
☐ **2.** 📅 Space it out
☐ **3.** 💛 Make it personal
☐ **4.** 🗣️ Say it out loud
☐ **5.** 👩‍🏫 Teach someone
☐ **6.** 😴 Sleep well

a) "The cosiest place in my home is the chair by my window."
b) Explain what you learned to a friend – or an imaginary student.
c) Cover the English side of your list and try to say the words.
d) Go to bed on time before an exam – don't study until 3 a.m.
e) Look at a word today, tomorrow, in three days and next week.
f) "Scissors, scissors, scissors…" all the way to the kitchen.

11 Say it better

common mistakes · 10 points

These sentences sound unnatural. Write a more natural version (2 points each). ⏱️ 19:14

😐 1. "Can you remember me to call my mum?" 😊 _____

😐 2. "I forgot my keys at home." 😊 _____

😐 3. "I don't remember of that day." 😊 _____

😐 4. "I memorise the words but after I forget." 😊 _____

😐 5. "Do you remember when we have gone to the beach?" 😊 _____



Lucy's tip: You **remember** something yourself. Someone else **reminds** you. 🔔 And when you say *where*, use **leave**: *"I left my keys at home."*

🧠 Brain dump!

recall · no points



Do this **tomorrow**. Close the worksheet and the video. Set a timer for **two minutes** and write **everything** you remember from the episode – words, numbers, names, stories. Then check. Every gap is a word to practise!

🏆 Make your own winners' box

try it · no points



Rafael's system – recall practice and spaced repetition, invented at a dinner table! ⏱️ 21:20

🃏	👧	🗣️	🔁	🏆
Write 10 new words on small cards: English on one side, your language on the other.	Someone picks a card at random and reads your language.	Say the English word – and make a sentence with it.	Wrong? The card goes back in the pile. Try again tomorrow!	Right three days in a row? Into the winners' box!

Who could test me? _____ **My first 3 words:** _____

🧑‍🏫 Teach it! (no points)

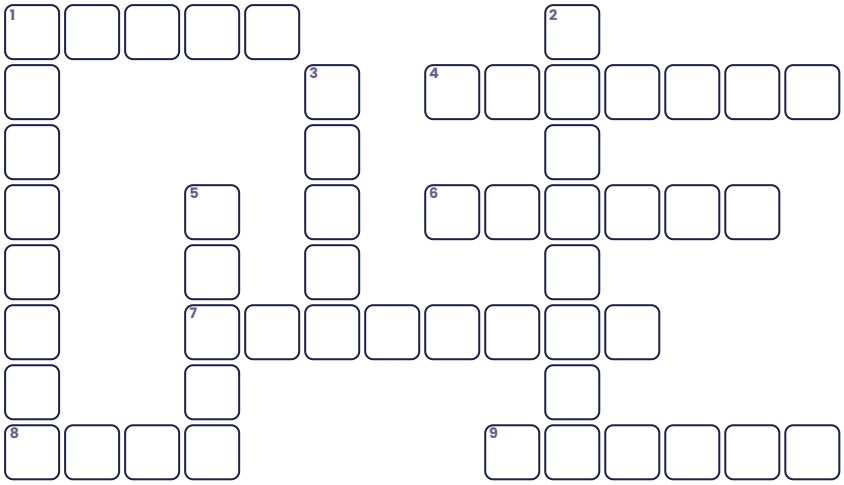
Lucy's third tip: when you explain something, you have to recall it and organise it. Explain **the forgetting curve** to an imaginary student in two sentences – without looking!

12 Memory crossword 🧩

puzzle · 10 points



Read the clues and write the words in the grid (1 point each). The number in brackets is the number of letters. Letters that cross help you!



➡️ Across

1. A bad memory: "I've got a memory like a ___." (5)
4. Walking through a ___ can make you forget what you wanted. (7)
6. Rafael's little ___ tested him every evening after dinner. (6)
7. A great memory: "She's got a memory like an ___." (8)
8. The restaurant near the bridge had amazing ___. (4)
9. To bring something back into your mind: to ___. (6)

⬇️ Down

1. Jack needed the ___ to open a parcel. (8)
2. Ebbinghaus learned lists of ___ syllables, like "dax" and "bok". (8)
3. The forgetting ___ drops very fast at the beginning. (5)
5. A good night's ___ might help your memory. (5)

13 Rafael and the winners' box 🏆

listening · 6 points



Listen at ⏱️ 21:20. Put the events in the right order. Write 1–6 in the boxes.

- ☐ 👧 Every evening, his little sister tested him with the cards.
- ☐ 😩 Rafael studied a lot, but he forgot almost everything.
- ☐ 🏆 After a year, the box had 1,000+ cards – and he got the job!
- ☐ 📉 Lucy told him about the forgetting curve and testing yourself.
- ☐ ✅ Cards he got right three days in a row went into a special box.
- ☐ 🃏 He started writing ten new words on small cards every evening.

Think about it 💭 (no points) Why did Rafael's sister start learning English too?

14 Your turn

writing · 8 points

2 points for each good sentence.



A. It slipped my mind! 🙈

Write about something you forgot – or a word on the tip of your tongue. *e.g. "Last week my friend's birthday completely slipped my mind."*

B. Make it personal 💛

Use two of today's words in sentences about **your** life. *e.g. "I need to brush up on my English before my job interview."*

⏱️ My five-word challenge

this week's mission

Choose five new words today. Make one sentence about your life for each. Then **recall** them without looking – tomorrow, in three days and next week!



#	New word	My sentence (about my life!)	Tomorrow	In 3 days	Next week
1			☐	☐	☐
2			☐	☐	☐
3			☐	☐	☐
4			☐	☐	☐
5			☐	☐	☐

✂️ Cut out and keep in your pocket

🙈 I FORGOT
It slipped my mind.
It's on the tip of my tongue.
What was it called again?

💡 I REMEMBER!
It came back to me.
That jogs my memory!
I know it by heart.

🔔 REMIND
Can you remind me to…?
Remember to call Mum!
I left my keys at home.

🧠 STUDY SMART
Test yourself.
Space it out.
Make it personal.

Can you do it now?

I can…	Not yet	Almost	Yes!
explain why doorways can make us forget.	😟	🙂	😄
explain why testing myself works better than reading again.	😟	🙂	😄
use remember, remind, forget and leave correctly.	😟	🙂	😄
say "It slipped my mind" and "It's on the tip of my tongue".	😟	🙂	😄



Share it with us! Tell us in the comments one thing that recently **slipped your mind**, or a word that's been **on the tip of your tongue**. Or share your favourite memory trick – we'd love to try it! 🧠

Answer key

Count your points and write your score on page 1!

0 · Warm-up & predict

Guess: b – after a week, the recallers remembered about 61%, the readers about 40%. · Predict: **camera** 📷 isn't in the episode.

1 · Key words · 2 · The big idea

1 c · 2 f · 3 i · 4 g · 5 a · 6 e · 7 b · 8 j · 9 h · 10 d
Big idea: c (2 points)

3 · Know it or hear it?

1 b · 2 a · 3 c · 4 c · 5 b · 6 a · 7 c · 8 b · 9 b · 10 c

4 · True or false?

1 T · 2 F (the objects were hidden) · 3 T · 4 F (he only tested himself) · 5 F (it's a possibility, not a proven answer) · 6 T

5 · Three studies · 6 · Read it or recall it?

5: 1 C · 2 A · 3 B · 4 A · 5 C · 6 B
6A: one week later – read 40% · recall 61%
6B: 1 recognising · 2 recalling · 3 recalling · 4 recognising

7 · "It's on the tip of my tongue!"

1 summer · 2 called · 3 tongue · 4 Italian · 5 second · 6 bridge · 7 back · 8 remind · A Marco's · B book

8 · Phrases to steal

1 c · 2 a · 3 d · 4 b

9 · Memory phrases · 10 · Remember to / -ing

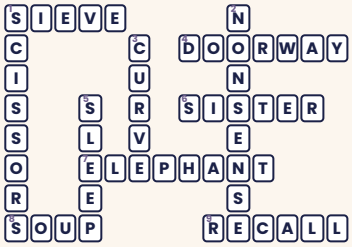
9: 1 heart · 2 up · 3 forgetful · 4 stick · 5 slipped · 6 jog
10: 1 to book · 2 meeting · 3 to test · 4 seeing · 5 to take · 6 learning

11 · Say it better (2 points each)

1 Can you remind me to call my mum? · 2 I left my keys at home. / I forgot my keys. · 3 I don't remember that day. · 4 I learn the words, but then I forget them. / …but they don't stick. · 5 Do you remember when we went to the beach?

12 · Crossword

Across: 1 sieve · 4 doorway · 6 sister · 7 elephant · 8 soup · 9 recall
Down: 1 scissors · 2 nonsense · 3 curve · 5 sleep



13 · Rafael's story · 14 · Your turn

1 😩 forgot everything · 2 📉 the forgetting curve · 3 🃏 ten cards every evening · 4 👧 sister tested him · 5 ✅ right three days in a row · 6 🏆 1,000+ cards and the job
Think about it: she heard all the words every night.
Six ways: 1 c · 2 e · 3 a · 4 f · 5 b · 6 d
14: your own answers – 2 points per good sentence.

Your score

90–100 🏆 **Winners' box!** · 70–89 🐘 **A memory like an elephant** · 50–69 👅 **On the tip of your tongue** · 0–49 🥣 **A memory like a sieve – try again tomorrow!**

Enjoyed this worksheet? 🎉
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